

Build yourself a Raspberry Pi-powered tablet crafted from wood!

An evangelist for MakerMedia, Michael Castor, has developed the PiPad—an all-in-one system that is usable, portable and Linux-based. And it uses a US\$ 40 Raspberry Pi Model B, Revision 2.0 for its core. The finished product is not the slimmest or lightest of devices, but has the kind of classic, elegant design cues that aren't often associated with mobile gadgetry.

The credit-card sized system board uses the Broadcom BCM2835 system on chip (SoC) and an ARM1176JZF-S 700MHZ processor. It also includes an on-board HF-capable VideoCore IV GPU offering high-definition video playback, and has 512 MB of RAM. An SD card is used for booting and long-term storage. For an interface, Castor used a 25.4-cm (10-inch) capacitive touchscreen from Chalk-Elec.com.

Italy to use open source technology in public administration!

All public administrations in Italy will now have to first consider re-used or free software before committing to proprietary licences, according to a set of new rules issued by the government that implement a change to the country's procurement law. Quite simply, Italy puts free software first in the public sector. Importantly, the new rules clearly include an enforcement mechanism, which deems that open source software be used first and foremost in all public sector mechanisms.

Italian public administrations are now obliged to give priority to free and open source software under the new rules. This preference, however, cannot be given without a comparative assessment.

developers claim the Accuraft S150 delivers position precision of 10 microns and can print at 300 mm/sec.

The printer is fast and precise, and prints at the click of a button. It can print bigger objects in parts. All that is needed is a design in the specified format, and the Accuraft S150 prints the entire object in parts, which can then be assembled using plastic welding or engineering grade adhesives. The build platform itself can be removed, which makes taking out the printed objects easy.

Microsoft to go to 'open access' for its researchers' publications

Even as Microsoft holds out against releasing its main products as open source, its Microsoft Research arm is moving towards open access for its researchers' publications.

"Microsoft Research is committed to disseminating the fruits of its research and scholarship as widely as possible because we recognise the benefits that accrue to scholarly enterprises from such wide dissemination, including more thorough review, consideration and critiques, and a general increase in scientific, scholarly and critical knowledge," the company's open access policy reads.

Peter Lee, head of Microsoft Research, discussed three main motivations for basic research at Microsoft in a recent interview: "The first relates to an aspiration to advance human knowledge, the second derives from a culture that relies deeply on the ambitions of individual researchers, and the last concerns promoting open publication of all research results and encouraging deep collaborations with academic researchers."

This open source smart thermostat is an Arduino alternative to Nest

Four engineers from Spark have pooled their skills and resources to make a new open source smart thermostat based on Arduino with the use of US\$ 70 worth of components. The new open source smart thermostat is created to provide an Arduino option to the Nest thermostat that was recently bought by Google for US\$ 3.2 billion.

The Spark smart thermostat is derived from the team's own Spark Core Arduino compatible wireless development board, on which a humidity and temperature sensor, an IR motion detector, along with a range of Adafruit 8 x 8 LED matrices to display information to users, have been added.

The primary sensor inside the open source smart thermometer is a Honeywell HumidCon temperature and humidity sensor, which shares the I2C bus with the displays. Here's what the team said about its open source creation: "All in all, it took about an hour to throw together this breadboarded prototype, although we had to order the components a couple of days beforehand. It took another couple of hours to pull together working firmware. The next step was to build an enclosure. The Nest enclosure uses glass and aluminium, which are both very pretty but not very handy for prototyping. Instead, we chose acrylic and wood."

You can shut down your PC with your Android phone!

Rebooting your PC is a fairly simple thing to do but you don't always have the time to do so, and another alternative to complete this task would be very handy. This is where the app, Droid Remote Lite, comes in. If your PC shutdown process is holding you up, then Droid Remote Lite is definitely the answer for you.

The app aims to give you the power to remotely perform four tasks on your PC—shut it down, restart it, put it into hibernation mode, and abort it. All you have to do is install the app on your Android-powered device, install the executable file on your PC, and make sure your Android phone and PC are on the same Wi-Fi network. Open the app and choose one of four different options: shutdown, restart, hibernate, and